

BILAL ESSAKINI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Front-End Developer with 2+ years of commercial experience building responsive, accessible, user-focused web applications using React.js, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5 and CSS3. Experienced across the delivery lifecycle: translating stakeholder requirements into maintainable solutions, integrating RESTful APIs, debugging production issues, and improving accessibility (WCAG 2.1), SEO and performance. Comfortable working in Agile/Scrum teams alongside design, product and engineering. Currently broadening backend and pipeline experience at OpenSignal while actively seeking to return to a Front-End Developer or Web Developer role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, PHP, Python, SQL, MongoDB

Frameworks & Libraries: React.js, jQuery, Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS, Node.js, Django, Laravel,

Front-End & UX: Responsive design, web accessibility WCAG 2.1, cross-browser compatibility, W3C standards, SEO, UX testing, Figma

APIs & Data: RESTful APIs, JSON, XML, web scraping, proxy configuration, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle SQL

CMS & Tooling: Squiz Matrix 6, Git, GitLab, GitHub, GitLab CI/CD, VS Code, Jira, Google Analytics, DXP reporting

Ways of Working: Agile/Scrum, CI/CD pipelines, code review, technical documentation, stakeholder communication

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Acquisition Engineer | OpenSignal

Dec 2025 – Present

- Build and maintain PHP-based data-collection systems and web scrapers that extract structured data from multiple sources, adapting parsing logic as site structures change.
- Configure and manage proxy pools and rotation to sustain reliable, large-scale data acquisition and minimise ratelimiting and IP blocking.
- Manage version control and CI/CD pipelines in GitLab, using merge requests and automated pipeline runs to test, review and deploy scraper and data-pipeline changes.
- Investigate scraper failures, resolve data-quality issues and document fixes to support SLA-driven delivery of recurring daily data feeds.
- Collaborate with engineering, product and data-quality teams to troubleshoot issues and drive continuous improvement.
- Applying CI/CD pipeline experience and version control practices directly transferable to front-end engineering workflows.

Web Developer | University of Hertfordshire

Mar 2025 – Nov 2025

- Built and maintained responsive, accessible web pages using HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, React.js, jQuery, Bootstrap and REST APIs.
- Configured and administered the Squiz Matrix 6 CMS, including content workflows, troubleshooting and staff training.
- Implemented WCAG 2.1 / W3C-compliant layouts and improved SEO, page performance and cross-device user journeys.
- Integrated third-party APIs to deliver dynamic content and translated stakeholder requirements into maintainable solutions.
- Produced documentation and training materials, improving consistency across web updates and reducing repeat support queries.

Graduate Web Developer | University of Hertfordshire

Mar 2024 – Feb 2025

- Developed responsive pages and campaign content with React.js, HTML5 and CSS3, contributing to a 40% uplift in user engagement.
- Partnered with designers to prototype user-focused interfaces, supporting a 30% improvement in measured site performance.
- Integrated REST APIs to surface dynamic content within Agile delivery cycles.
- Strengthened accessibility across web content in line with WCAG 2.1, improving compliance by ~20%.
- Analysed traffic and user behaviour with Google Analytics and DXP reporting, supporting a 35% increase in site traffic.
- Managed CMS workflows in Squiz Matrix 6 using XML and JSON.

PROJECTS

Portfolio Website — React.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion, Vercel

- Built and deployed a mobile-first portfolio showcasing project work, front-end skills and responsive design.
- Implemented responsive layouts, dynamic routing and accessible navigation. Live: bilallessakini.com

Cinema Ticket Booking Web App — HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, MySQL

- Designed and built the full front-end booking interface including seat selection UI, form validation and responsive layout.
- Implemented PHP backend logic and MySQL database integration, plus user authentication and bookingmanagement features.

Face Recognition Attendance System — Python, OpenCV, scikit-learn, pandas

- Built a real-time face-recognition prototype with a simple UI for attendance capture and reporting.
- Used pandas with CSV and Excel outputs to support attendance-data handling and reporting.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science | University of Hertfordshire

Relevant modules: Web Development, Algorithms & Data Structures, Artificial Intelligence, Agile, Networking & Security, Databases.

Level 3 Diploma in IT | Central Bedfordshire College

2020

Level 2 Diploma in ICT Systems Support | Central Bedfordshire College

2018

LANGUAGES

English • Italian • Arabic